KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 5: CHARTING THE COURSE · WEEK 23 · READING

Butterflies in Music City — Teacher Lesson Plan & Answer Key

Learning objectives: Students tell literal from figurative language, identify and explain similes, metaphors, personification, hyperbole and idioms, explain how figurative language and word choice show a character's feelings and set the mood in a story and a poem, and rewrite figurative passages in plain, literal words.

Duration: 35–45 minutes
Materials: Computer or tablet with the lesson open · pencil · printed Pre & Post sheet

Lesson flow (as it appears on screen)

1. Slide 0 — Intro and name capture: at a summer fiddle camp in Nashville, Tennessee (Music City, on the Cumberland River), Adisa has to play her first solo. The student reads her story and a poem about an old concert hall. The student types first and last name so results go to KingCretot Experience. Read the scoring rules together: 2 tries per question, Pathway Points only for a correct first try, and the answer plus the reason appear after the 2nd miss. Typed one-word answers ignore capital letters and are accepted when the answer contains an accepted word.
2. Slide 1 — Warm-Up: Week 22 Review (8 pts, 4 each): firsthand and secondhand accounts.
3. Slide 2 — Pencil Break (Pre): the student opens or prints the Pre/Post sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W23.pdf) and completes Page 1 (Pre-Lesson Warm-Up) on paper before any teaching.
4. Slide 3 — Picture It: Literal or Figurative? The five kinds (simile, metaphor, personification, hyperbole, idiom), each with a camp example and its real meaning; word choice (marched, tiptoed, dragged herself); and mood. Three questions: Could this be literally true? What does it really mean? What does it show?
5. Slide 4 — Vocabulary Round-Up: 8 flip cards (simile, metaphor, personification, hyperbole, idiom, mood, betrayed, trembling).
6. Slide 5 — Your Turn: Using the Words (8 pts, 4 each): one multiple-choice and one typed vocabulary item.
7. Slide 6 — Text A: Butterflies in Music City (5 pts). Read it aloud together. Adisa's nerves (butterflies, as pale as a sheet of paper, "a million times," the air was an oven, cold feet, knees made of jelly) turn to joy (her bow began to dance, the melody soared like a bird, flying high). Use the paragraph numbers.
8. Slide 7 — Text B: What the Old Hall Hears (5 pts). A four-stanza poem in which an old Nashville concert hall is the main character. Watch the personification and metaphors, and how the mood moves from quiet to bold and encouraging.
9. Slide 8 — What the Words Show (10 pts, 5 each): what each figure shows about Adisa's feelings or the mood, across both texts.
10. Slide 9 — Teach: Explain It Like a Pro. Four steps: name it, say what it literally says, say what it really means, and say what it shows. Compare the weak and strong explanations of "her face nearly split in two," and discuss connotation (the audience roared versus clapped).
11. Slide 10 — Figurative Language Detective (12 pts, 6 each): pick the strongest explanation, test how one word changes the mood, and catch the mistakes.

12. Slide 11 — Fix the Sentence, Part 1 (8 pts, 4 each): each item names the one kind of fix. The whole sentence is checked exactly (straight or curly quotes and extra spaces are OK). The corrected sentence appears after the 2nd miss.
13. Slide 12 — Fix the Sentence, Part 2 (8 pts, 4 each): two more sentences, same rules. Titles of poems and stories go in quotation marks, with commas and periods inside.
14. Slide 13 — Back It Up With Evidence (4 pts): quote the figurative sentence named in the item, starting with the tag shown, a comma, and the exact words in quotation marks with the end mark inside. Checked exactly.
15. Slide 14 — Writer's Turn: Say It Plainly (6 pts): one typed literal rewrite auto-checked by rules: a minimum word count; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (allowed names count as one word); and every key idea included in plain words. Feedback names the rule that was missed, and a model answer appears after the 2nd miss. Encourage covering the original before writing.
16. Slide 15 — Match-Up Round (10 pts): the five kinds, reading terms (mood, literal, figurative, connotation, speaker) or idioms matched to meanings (a different set each attempt), 2 pts each on the first try.
17. Slide 16 — Speed Trail (bonus XP only): 3 quick questions against the student's own best time.
18. Slide 17 — Boss Challenge (16 pts, 8 each): two-step items across both texts (name the kind, then decide what it shows about the character or the mood).
19. Slide 18 — Pencil Break (Post): the student completes Page 2 (Post-Lesson Activity) of the same sheet (grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W23.pdf), including the writing item and the ★ Challenge if time allows, before seeing the score.
20. Slide 19 — Results (Words That Sing!): the score out of 100 is sent to KingCretot Experience. 85 or higher shows "Word Wizard!" with the congratulations message "Word wizard! You heard what the words were really saying!" and a big confetti burst; below 85 shows "Keep Going!" with encouragement ("You're getting closer, and every try makes you stronger."), and the next attempt brings a fresh question set (sets rotate 1, 2, 3). Both messages remind the student to finish the Post-Lesson Challenge sheet.

Lesson answer key with reasoning

Every scored item the student sees, in order, across all three rotating question sets. Each item allows 2 tries and earns Pathway Points only on a correct first try. The "why" is the same reasoning shown on screen after a second missed try.

WARM-UP: WEEK 22 REVIEW (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
`rv1_s0`	Set 1: Which of these is a FIRSTHAND account of the Apollo 11 Moon landing? [Neil Armstrong's own words, radioed from the Moon and written down in NASA's transcript / An encyclopedia article about the mission, written years later / A textbook chapter about the space race / A biography of Armstrong written by a historian]	**Neil Armstrong's own words, radioed from the Moon and written down in NASA's transcript**	Armstrong was on the Moon, so his recorded words are firsthand. The encyclopedia, textbook, and biography were written by people who were not there, using other sources (Week 22).
`rv2_s0`	Set 1: Type your answer: an account written by someone who was NOT there, using research, like an encyclopedia article, is called a ___ account.	**secondhand** (also accepted: second-hand, second hand)	A writer who was not there and learned about the event from other sources writes a secondhand account (Week 22).

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
rv1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation is correct? What does a firsthand account usually give that a secondhand account often does NOT? [The feelings and sensory details of a person who was there / The most complete list of dates and facts from many sources / Only events that were made up by the writer / Background about what happened years before and after]	**The feelings and sensory details of a person who was there**	A firsthand writer was there, so the account can share what the writer saw, heard, and felt. A secondhand account usually gives more facts, dates, and background (Week 22).
rv2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: firsthand accounts are often told with the pronoun I and the pronoun ___ (a word that means "my group and me").	**we** (also accepted: us, our)	A firsthand writer who was there with others writes "we" (Week 22).
rv1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Alvin says, "An encyclopedia article about Apollo 11 is a firsthand account because it is full of facts." What is wrong? [Having facts does not make an account firsthand. Firsthand means the writer was there, and the encyclopedia writer was not. / Nothing is wrong. Any account with facts is firsthand. / Encyclopedias never include facts about space. / An encyclopedia article is firsthand only if it has pictures.]	**Having facts does not make an account firsthand. Firsthand means the writer was there, and the encyclopedia writer was not.**	What makes an account firsthand is who wrote it: someone who was there. An encyclopedia writer studied the event later, so the article is secondhand (Week 22).
rv2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: an account by someone who saw or took part in the event is called a ___ account.	**firsthand** (also accepted: first-hand, first hand)	Someone who was there writes a firsthand account (Week 22).

YOUR TURN: USING THE WORDS (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s0	Set 1: From the poem: "When all the crowds have wandered home / and every seat is bare." Using the context, what does bare most likely mean? [Empty, with no one in it / Covered in dust / Painted a bright color / Broken and falling apart]	**Empty, with no one in it**	The crowds have all gone home, so no one is sitting in the seats. Here, bare means empty.
v2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: a comparison of two unlike things that uses the word like or as is called a ___.	**simile** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	A comparison using like or as is a simile.
v1_s1	Set 2: All four sentences describe the same hot cabin. Which one is a METAPHOR? [The practice cabin was a furnace. / The practice cabin was as hot as a furnace. / The practice cabin was very hot. / The practice cabin sighed in the heat.]	**The practice cabin was a furnace.**	A metaphor says one thing IS another without like or as. "As hot as a furnace" is a simile, "very hot" is literal, and a cabin that sighs is personification.
v2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: giving human actions or feelings to an object, animal, or idea, like "the floor complained," is called ___.	**personification** (also accepted: personify, personifying)	Giving human actions to something that is not human is personification.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
v1_s2	Set 3: From the story: “The first notes came out thin and shaky, like a kitten mewing in the rain.” Using the context, what does mewing most likely mean? [Making a soft, high crying sound / Purring loudly and happily / Running in circles / Sleeping in a warm spot]	**Making a soft, high crying sound**	The notes are “thin and shaky,” and they are compared to a kitten out in the rain. A small, unhappy kitten makes a soft, high cry. That is mewing.
v2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: a huge exaggeration that is not meant to be taken literally, like “I’ve told you a billion times,” is called ___.	**hyperbole** (also accepted with “a” or “an” or in the plural)	A huge exaggeration is hyperbole.

TEXT A: THE STORY (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sa_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: in paragraph 1, Adisa wakes up with “a stomach full of ___.” (This idiom means she feels very nervous.)	**butterflies** (also accepted: butterfly)	Paragraph 1 says Adisa “woke up with a stomach full of butterflies.” Having butterflies in your stomach is an idiom for feeling nervous.
sa_s1	Set 2: In paragraph 3, the first notes come out “thin and shaky, like a kitten mewing in the rain.” Which explanation of why the author uses this simile is correct? [It shows that Adisa’s playing sounds weak and unsure because she is nervous. / It shows that a real kitten is hiding in the practice cabin. / It shows that rain is falling on the cabin roof. / It shows that Adisa’s playing is loud and powerful.]	**It shows that Adisa’s playing sounds weak and unsure because she is nervous.**	No kitten is really there. The simile compares her notes to a small, sad sound to show that her nerves are making her playing weak and shaky.
sa_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: in paragraph 4, Mr. Aldo uses a two-word idiom that means “feel nervous or scared right before doing something.” Type the two words.	**cold feet**	Mr. Aldo says, “Everybody gets cold feet before a show.” Getting cold feet means feeling nervous before something big.

TEXT B: THE POEM (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
sb_s0	Set 1: Stanza 2 says, “its windows are a hundred eyes.” Which explanation is correct? [It is a metaphor, because it says the windows ARE eyes without using like or as. / It is a simile, because it compares windows and eyes. / It is hyperbole, because one hundred is a big number. / It is an idiom, because people say it every day.]	**It is a metaphor, because it says the windows ARE eyes without using like or as.**	The line says the windows ARE eyes, with no like or as, so it is a metaphor. It makes the hall seem like it has been watching every show.
sb_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: stanza 3 uses personification. Which part of the hall “remembers trembling hands”? Type one word.	**stage** (also accepted: the stage)	Stanza 3 begins, “The stage remembers trembling hands.” A stage cannot really remember, so this is personification.
sb_s2	Set 3: How does the MOOD change from stanza 1 to stanza 4? [It changes from quiet and peaceful to bold and encouraging. / It changes from joyful to angry. / It changes from scary to sad. / It stays gloomy the whole time.]	**It changes from quiet and peaceful to bold and encouraging.**	Stanza 1 is calm: an empty hall at midnight. Stanza 4 speaks straight to the reader, “don’t fear the waiting crowd,” and asks for a song “sung loud,” so the mood becomes bold and encouraging.

WHAT THE WORDS SHOW (5 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qp1_s0	Set 1: Paragraph 5 says that Adisa's "knees were made of jelly." What does this metaphor show? [She is so nervous that her legs feel weak and wobbly. / She ate jelly with her pancakes that morning. / She hurt her knees during practice. / She is excited to run across the stage.]	**She is so nervous that her legs feel weak and wobbly.**	Her knees are not really jelly. The metaphor shows that her nerves make her legs feel weak and shaky, right before her solo.
qp2_s0	Set 1: Type your answer: two steps. In paragraph 1, the idiom "butterflies" shows that Adisa is nervous. Which two-word idiom at the end of paragraph 6 shows that she now feels very happy? She was still ___ ___.	**flying high**	Paragraph 6 ends, "She was still flying high when Aedan wrapped her in a hug." Flying high is an idiom for feeling very happy and proud.
qp1_s1	Set 2: How does the author's figurative language show the MOOD changing from paragraph 3 to paragraph 6? Which explanation is correct? [Paragraph 3 uses tense, uncomfortable images (an oven, a complaining floor, a mewing kitten); paragraph 6 uses free, joyful images (a dancing bow, a bird finding the sky). / Both paragraphs use the same gloomy images, so the mood never changes. / Paragraph 3 is joyful and paragraph 6 is scary. / Neither paragraph uses any figurative language.]	**Paragraph 3 uses tense, uncomfortable images (an oven, a complaining floor, a mewing kitten); paragraph 6 uses free, joyful images (a dancing bow, a bird finding the sky).**	The figurative language in paragraph 3 makes the scene feel hot, cramped, and nervous. In paragraph 6, the bow dances and the melody soars like a bird, so the mood becomes joyful.
qp2_s1	Set 2: Type your answer: two steps. Mr. Aldo's metaphor is "Music is a conversation, not a test." Which word in it names what Adisa had been treating her solo like, worrying about every note? Type one word.	**test** (also accepted with "a" or "an" or in the plural)	Adisa was trying to play every note perfectly, as if she were taking a test. Mr. Aldo wants her to treat music like a conversation instead.
qp1_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Alessia wrote: "'The old wooden floor creaked complaints' is a simile because it compares the floor to a person." What is wrong? [It is personification, not a simile. There is no like or as; the floor is given a human action, complaining. / Nothing is wrong. It is a simile. / It is hyperbole, because floors are very old. / It is an idiom, because people complain about floors.]	**It is personification, not a simile. There is no like or as; the floor is given a human action, complaining.**	A simile must use like or as, and this line has neither. Giving a floor the human action of complaining is personification.
qp2_s2	Set 3: Type your answer: two steps. Both texts use personification. In the poem, the hall "stretches wooden arms." In paragraph 5 of the story, what "blinked awake one by one"? Type two words.	**stage lights** (also accepted: lights, the lights)	Paragraph 5 says, "the stage lights blinked awake one by one." Lights cannot really wake up, so this is personification.

FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE DETECTIVE (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
d1_s0	Set 1: Which is the BEST explanation of Adisa's line "I've practiced this song a million times"? [It is hyperbole. She has not really practiced a million times, but the exaggeration shows how frustrated she is that her fingers still forget the middle part. / It is a simile, because it uses a number to compare. / It is literal. She practiced exactly one million times. / I think practicing is boring, so this is my favorite line.]	**It is hyperbole. She has not really practiced a million times, but the exaggeration shows how frustrated she is that her fingers still forget the middle part.**	No one could really practice a song a million times, so it is hyperbole. The exaggeration shows her frustration. The other answers name the wrong kind, take it literally, or give an opinion.
d2_s0	Set 1: Word choice: the author wrote, "Her bow began to dance." Which replacement word would change the MOOD the most? [scrape / glide / skip / twirl]	**scrape**	Glide, skip, and twirl all still feel light and happy. "Her bow began to scrape" sounds harsh and unpleasant, so it would change the joyful mood the most.
d1_s1	Set 2: Which sentence from the story is LITERAL, with no figurative language? [She walked to the microphone, closed her eyes, and pictured her grandmother humming this same tune on the porch back home. / In the practice cabin, the air was an oven. / The stage lights blinked awake one by one. / When Adisa's name was called, her knees were made of jelly.]	**She walked to the microphone, closed her eyes, and pictured her grandmother humming this same tune on the porch back home.**	Every part of the first sentence could really happen. The air is not an oven (metaphor), lights do not wake up (personification), and knees are not jelly (metaphor).
d2_s1	Set 2: Adlai says, "Idioms and metaphors are the same thing." Which explanation is correct? [No. A metaphor makes a new comparison to paint a picture; an idiom is a common saying whose meaning you have to learn, like "cold feet." / Yes. Both always use the word like. / No. Idioms are always longer than metaphors. / Yes. Both mean exactly what the words say.]	**No. A metaphor makes a new comparison to paint a picture; an idiom is a common saying whose meaning you have to learn, like "cold feet."**	A metaphor compares two things ("the air was an oven"). An idiom is a familiar phrase whose meaning cannot be figured out from its words ("cold feet" has nothing to do with feet).
d1_s2	Set 3: Which words BEST describe the mood of paragraph 6? [Triumphant and joyful / Tense and worried / Gloomy and lonely / Calm and sleepy]	**Triumphant and joyful**	In paragraph 6, the bow dances, the melody soars, the audience roars to its feet, and Adisa grins and flies high. The mood is triumphant and joyful.
d2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Aleta explained the line "You look as pale as a sheet of paper": "This is a metaphor that shows Aedan is sick." Which answer names ALL of her mistakes? [It is a simile, not a metaphor, because it uses "as," and Aedan is describing Adisa's nervous face, not saying he is sick. / Only the kind is wrong; Aedan really is sick. / Only the person is wrong; it really is a metaphor. / Nothing is wrong with her explanation.]	**It is a simile, not a metaphor, because it uses "as," and Aedan is describing Adisa's nervous face, not saying he is sick.**	The comparison uses "as," so it is a simile. Aedan says it to Adisa, so it shows how pale and nervous she looks. Aleta made both mistakes.

FIX THE SENTENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
fs1_s0	Set 1: Title punctuation: put quotation marks around the poem's title. In the poem What the Old Hall Hears, the windows are eyes.	**In the poem "What the Old Hall Hears," the windows are eyes.**	The title of a poem goes inside quotation marks, and the comma after the title goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s0	Set 1: Dialogue punctuation: add the missing comma. "Eat something" Aedan said.	**"Eat something," Aedan said.**	When the speaker tag comes after the spoken words, a comma goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s0	Set 1: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. Suddenly the stage lights blinked awake.	**Suddenly, the stage lights blinked awake.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like "Suddenly."
fs4_s0	Set 1: Grammar: fix the verb so it agrees with the subject. The fiddle and the banjo plays the same tune.	**The fiddle and the banjo play the same tune.**	"The fiddle and the banjo" is a compound subject (two instruments), so it needs the plural verb "play," not "plays."
fs1_s1	Set 2: Commas in a series: add the commas between the three actions. The melody climbed swooped and soared over the crowd.	**The melody climbed, swooped, and soared over the crowd.** (also accepted: The melody climbed, swooped and soared over the crowd.)	Use commas to separate the three actions in a series: climbed, swooped, and soared.
fs2_s1	Set 2: Dialogue capitalization: fix the capital-letter mistake. Mr. Aldo said, "everybody gets cold feet before a show."	**Mr. Aldo said, "Everybody gets cold feet before a show."**	The first word of a quoted sentence is capitalized, even in the middle of your sentence.
fs3_s1	Set 2: Comma after an introductory word: add the missing comma. However Adisa's first notes were thin and shaky.	**However, Adisa's first notes were thin and shaky.**	Put a comma after an introductory word like "However."
fs4_s1	Set 2: Grammar: fix the its / it's mistake. The old hall stretches it's wooden arms.	**The old hall stretches its wooden arms.**	"It's" means "it is." The arms belong to the hall, so use the possessive "its" with no apostrophe.
fs1_s2	Set 3: Title capitalization: fix the three capital-letter mistakes in the title. My favorite story is "butterflies in music city."	**My favorite story is "Butterflies in Music City."**	Capitalize the first word and the important words of a title (Butterflies, Music, City), but not a short word like "in" in the middle. The period goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs2_s2	Set 3: Dialogue punctuation: move the question mark to the right spot. "Why do my fingers forget"? asked Adisa.	**"Why do my fingers forget?" asked Adisa.**	The question mark belongs to the words Adisa asked, so it goes inside the closing quotation mark.
fs3_s2	Set 3: Comma after an introductory clause: add the missing comma. When her name was called Adisa walked to the microphone.	**When her name was called, Adisa walked to the microphone.**	Put a comma after an introductory clause like "When her name was called."
fs4_s2	Set 3: Grammar: fix the their / there / they're mistake. The campers carried there instruments to the stage.	**The campers carried their instruments to the stage.**	The instruments belong to the campers, so use the possessive "their," not "there."

BACK IT UP WITH EVIDENCE (4 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
qt_s0	Set 1: This sentence uses a metaphor to show how nervous Adisa is. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 5): When Adisa's name was called, her knees were made of jelly. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "When Adisa's name was called, her knees were made of jelly."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word (including the apostrophe and the comma after "called") inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s1	Set 2: This simile shows that Adisa's playing has become free and joyful. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 6): The melody climbed, swooped, and soared over the crowd like a bird that had finally found the sky. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "The melody climbed, swooped, and soared over the crowd like a bird that had finally found the sky."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and both commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside.
qt_s2	Set 3: This sentence uses a metaphor and personification to create a tense, uncomfortable mood. Quote it. Start with the tag shown, then add a comma, quotation marks, and the end mark. Original (Text A, paragraph 3): In the practice cabin, the air was an oven, and the old wooden floor creaked complaints under every step. Start with: The author writes	**The author writes, "In the practice cabin, the air was an oven, and the old wooden floor creaked complaints under every step."**	Put a comma after the tag, then copy every exact word and both commas inside quotation marks, with the period inside.

WRITER'S TURN: SAY IT PLAINLY (6 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s0	Set 1: Rewrite paragraph 3 of the story in plain, literal words. Tell what really happened and how Adisa felt. Text A, paragraph 3: In the practice cabin, the air was an oven, and the old wooden floor creaked complaints under every step. Adisa lifted her bow. The first notes came out thin and shaky, like a kitten mewing in the rain. She stopped and stared at the strings as if they had betrayed her. Use at least 15 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Single words like cabin and floor are fine.) Name the character: include Adisa (or she). Say what the oven metaphor really means: the cabin was hot. Say what the complaining floor really means: the floor creaked or made noise. Say how her playing really sounded: weak, quiet, shaky, or nervous. Original: "In the practice cabin, the air was an oven, and the old wooden floor creaked complaints under every step. Adisa lifted her bow. The first notes came out thin and shaky, like a kitten mewing in the rain. She stopped and stared at the strings as if they had betrayed her."	**Sample:** Adisa practiced in a very hot cabin with a noisy floor, and her first notes sounded weak and nervous, so she stopped and felt upset with her fiddle.	A strong literal rewrite says what the figurative language really means: the cabin was hot (not an oven), the floor creaked (it did not complain), and Adisa's nervous playing sounded weak. Auto-check rubric: at least 15 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original; must include: adisa or she; hot or warm or heat or stuffy or steam or sweat; creak or squeak or nois or loud or floor; weak or shaky or quiet or soft or thin or nervous or unsure or bad or wobbl or off or wrong.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
wt_s1	Set 2: Rewrite paragraph 6 of the story in plain, literal words. Tell what really happened and how Adisa felt. Text A, paragraph 6: Her bow began to dance. The melody climbed, swooped, and soared over the crowd like a bird that had finally found the sky. When the last note faded, the audience roared to its feet. Adisa grinned so wide that her face nearly split in two. She was still flying high when Aedan wrapped her in a hug. Use at least 18 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the text. (Names like Adisa and Aedan are fine.) Name the character: include Adisa (or she). Say what she did: she played the song (or music, tune, or solo). Say HOW she played, in plain words: well, beautifully, confidently, or smoothly. Say what the audience really did: cheered, clapped, or stood up. Say how Adisa really felt: happy, proud, or thrilled. Original: “Her bow began to dance. The melody climbed, swooped, and soared over the crowd like a bird that had finally found the sky. When the last note faded, the audience roared to its feet. Adisa grinned so wide that her face nearly split in two. She was still flying high when Aedan wrapped her in a hug.”	**Sample:** Adisa played the tune beautifully and with confidence, the people watching stood up and cheered loudly, and she smiled because she felt proud and happy.	A strong literal rewrite turns each figure into plain words: the dancing bow and soaring bird mean she played beautifully, the roar means the audience cheered, and the face splitting and flying high mean she was very happy. Auto-check rubric: at least 18 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original (names count as one word); must include: adisa or she; play or music or song or melody or tune or fiddle or solo; well or beautiful or great or strong or confiden or free or good or amazing or wonderful or smooth or graceful or lively or perfect; cheer or clap or applau or stood or stand or yell; happy or proud or smil or grin or joy or excit or thrill or glad or delight.
wt_s2	Set 3: Rewrite the whole poem in plain, literal words. Cover the empty hall at night, what it “remembers,” and the speaker’s message. Text B, “What the Old Hall Hears”: Look back at the poem on the Text B slide, or use the key lines here: “When all the crowds have wandered home / and every seat is bare” … “The stage remembers trembling hands” … “don’t fear the waiting crowd. / The hall has heard a million songs / and still wants yours, sung loud.” Use at least 20 words. Do not copy 4 or more words in a row from the poem. Name the main character: the hall (or building or auditorium). Include stanza 1: say it is empty, quiet, or nighttime. Include stanza 3 or 4: mention being nervous, scared, or brave. Include the message: say what the speaker wants the reader to do (sing, play, or perform). Original: “When all the crowds have wandered home and every seat is bare, the old hall stretches wooden arms and breathes the midnight air. Its pews are pockets full of songs from summers long ago; its windows are a hundred eyes that watched each nervous show. The stage remembers trembling hands, a singer's shaky start, and how one brave and honest note can calm a racing heart. So when it's your turn in the lights, don't fear the waiting crowd. The hall has heard a million songs and still wants yours, sung loud.”	**Sample:** At night the building is empty, and it seems to recall many years of past shows and nervous performers, so it tells new singers not to be afraid and to perform boldly.	A strong literal rewrite tells what the poem really means: the empty hall at night has hosted many performers who were nervous, and the speaker encourages the reader to perform bravely. Auto-check rubric: at least 20 words; no 4 or more words in a row copied from the original; must include: hall or building or auditorium or theater or place or venue or stage; night or empty or quiet or midnight or dark or alone or nobody or no one or gone or left; nervous or scared or afraid or fear or brave or courage or shak or trembl or worried; sing or play or perform or song or music.

MATCH-UP ROUND (2 POINTS PER FIRST-TRY MATCH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
match_s0_1	Set 1: Match simile	**compares using like or as**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_2	Set 1: Match metaphor	**says one thing IS another**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_3	Set 1: Match personification	**gives human actions to a thing**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_4	Set 1: Match hyperbole	**a huge exaggeration**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s0_5	Set 1: Match idiom	**a saying that means something other than its words**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_1	Set 2: Match mood	**the feeling a text creates in the reader**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_2	Set 2: Match literal	**meaning exactly what the words say**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_3	Set 2: Match figurative	**not meant word for word; paints a picture**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_4	Set 2: Match connotation	**the feeling a word carries**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s1_5	Set 2: Match speaker	**the voice talking in a poem**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_1	Set 3: Match cold feet	**feeling nervous before a big event**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_2	Set 3: Match butterflies in your stomach	**a jittery, nervous feeling**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_3	Set 3: Match flying high	**feeling very happy and proud**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_4	Set 3: Match break a leg	**good luck before a show**	2 points if matched on the first try.
match_s2_5	Set 3: Match betrayed	**turned against someone who trusted you**	2 points if matched on the first try.

BOSS CHALLENGE (8 POINTS EACH)

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b1_s0	Set 1: Two-step: “Adisa grinned so wide that her face nearly split in two.” Step 1, name the kind. Step 2, say what it shows. Which answer gets BOTH steps right? [Hyperbole; it shows that she is extremely happy and proud. / Hyperbole; it shows that she has hurt her face. / Simile; it shows that she is extremely happy and proud. / Personification; it shows that she is still nervous.]	**Hyperbole; it shows that she is extremely happy and proud.**	Her face could not really split, so it is a huge exaggeration: hyperbole. It shows how thrilled she is after her solo. The other answers get the kind wrong, the meaning wrong, or both.

ID	Question	Answer	Why (explain to student)
b2_s0	Set 1: Two-step: both texts move from nervousness to courage. Step 1, find lines from the POEM. Step 2, make sure they show that change. Which pair does BOTH? [“The stage remembers trembling hands” and then “The hall has heard a million songs / and still wants yours, sung loud.” / “her knees were made of jelly” and then “Her bow began to dance.” / “the old hall stretches wooden arms” and then “breathes the midnight air.” / “Its pews are pockets full of songs” and then “its windows are a hundred eyes.”]	**“The stage remembers trembling hands” and then “The hall has heard a million songs / and still wants yours, sung loud.”**	The trembling hands show nerves, and the last lines encourage the reader to sing loud. The jelly-and-dance pair shows the change, but it comes from the story, not the poem. The other two pairs only describe the hall.
b1_s1	Set 2: Which explanation of how BOTH texts use personification is correct? [In the story, objects like the floor and the stage lights act alive to set the mood; in the poem, the whole hall becomes a character who remembers and encourages performers. / Only the story uses personification; the poem uses only similes. / Only the poem uses personification; the story uses only idioms. / Both texts use personification to show that buildings are dangerous.]	**In the story, objects like the floor and the stage lights act alive to set the mood; in the poem, the whole hall becomes a character who remembers and encourages performers.**	The story’s floor “creaked complaints” and the lights “blinked awake,” which set each scene’s mood. In the poem, the hall stretches, breathes, remembers, and wants your song, so it acts like a wise, kind character.
b2_s1	Set 2: Two-step: Step 1, find the METAPHOR. Step 2, make sure it shows a character feeling NERVOUS. Which sentence does BOTH? [My heart was a drum pounding inside my chest. / My heart pounded like a drum. / My heart beat fast before the show. / My heart has beaten a billion times today.]	**My heart was a drum pounding inside my chest.**	“My heart was a drum” says one thing IS another, so it is a metaphor, and a pounding heart shows nerves. “Like a drum” is a simile, “beat fast” is literal, and “a billion times” is hyperbole.
b1_s2	Set 3: Which NEW sentence uses personification AND fits the joyful mood of paragraph 6? [The fiddle sang with joy as the crowd cheered. / The fiddle was as loud as thunder. / The broken string groaned in pain at the sad end of the song. / The fiddle played a song for the crowd.]	**The fiddle sang with joy as the crowd cheered.**	A fiddle cannot really feel joy or sing, so it is personification, and the feeling is joyful. “As loud as thunder” is a simile, the groaning string is personification with a sad mood, and the last sentence is literal.
b2_s2	Set 3: Find the mistake! Adlai wrote: “The line ‘The hall has heard a million songs’ is literal, because old halls host lots of concerts.” Which explanation is correct? [It is hyperbole. “A million” exaggerates to show how many performers the hall has heard, so one more nervous singer is nothing to fear. / He is right. The poem gives the exact number of songs. / It is a simile, because it compares the hall to songs. / It is an idiom that means the hall is too loud.]	**It is hyperbole. “A million” exaggerates to show how many performers the hall has heard, so one more nervous singer is nothing to fear.**	The number is exaggerated on purpose, so it is hyperbole. It helps the speaker encourage the reader: the hall has heard so many songs that it is ready to welcome yours.

Pre & Post sheet answer guide

Many items are open-ended. Grade for genuine understanding and complete sentences, not exact wording. Sheet: grade4-5/prepost/KCE_Reading_PrePost_G4-5W23.pdf.

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	Review: which is a firsthand account of Apollo 11?	a) Buzz Aldrin's words radioed from the Moon. He was there, so it is firsthand. The 2020 website article was written later by someone who was not there, so it is secondhand.
2	"The practice room was a refrigerator." Literal or figurative?	Figurative (a metaphor). It means the practice room was very cold.
3	Which sentence uses like or as to compare?	Her voice was as sweet as honey.
4	Another saying and its real meaning	Answers vary (for example, "cold feet" means feeling nervous before something big; "piece of cake" means very easy). Check that the real meaning is different from the words.
5	One sentence about feeling nervous, using a comparison	Answers vary. Look for a simile or metaphor that shows the feeling (for example, "My heart pounded like a drum before the spelling bee.").

POST-LESSON CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	a) The tuba grumbled in the corner. b) My banjo case weighs a million pounds.	a) Personification: a tuba cannot grumble; it made a low, rumbling sound. b) Hyperbole: the case does not really weigh a million pounds; it feels very heavy.
2	Alvin calls "Her fingers flew like sparrows" a metaphor	Model: The line uses like, so it is a simile, not a metaphor. Fixed explanation: "Her fingers flew like sparrows" is a simile, because it compares her fingers to sparrows using like. It means her fingers moved quickly and lightly.
3	Be the editor	a) In the story "Butterflies in Music City," Adisa plays a solo. b) "Take a deep breath," Mr. Aldo said.
4	Writing: how the figurative language shows Adisa's feelings changing (4–5 sentences)	Grading note: nervous at the start, joyful at the end; one correctly punctuated quotation; one sentence beginning "However,". Model: At the start of the story, Adisa wakes up with "a stomach full of butterflies," which shows she is nervous. When her name is called, her knees feel like jelly. However, once she starts to play, "Her bow began to dance." The melody soars like a bird, and she is still flying high at the end, which shows that she feels proud and happy.

★ CHALLENGE

#	Prompt	Model answer / grading note
1	A thunderstorm at camp: simile, metaphor, personification	Answers vary (for example, simile: The thunder boomed like a bass drum. Metaphor: The sky was a black blanket. Personification: The wind pounded on the cabin door.). Check that each sentence is the kind it claims to be.